

Megan Wang

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EDUCATION

Brown University

Providence, RI

Bachelor of Science in Neuroscience, Bachelor of Arts in Early Modern World

Expected Graduation Date: May 2026

GPA: 3.94/4.0

University of California, Los Angeles

Los Angeles, CA

Bachelor of Science in Neuroscience

September 2022-June 2023

GPA: 4.0/4.0

Honors: Dean's List (Fall 2022, Winter 2023, Spring 2023)

Transferred to Brown University as a first-semester sophomore.

SCIENTIFIC INTERESTS

I am broadly interested in understanding the neurobiological mechanisms behind addiction in relation to individual behavior, as well as the role stress plays in substance use disorders. I aim to characterize the morphology of a circuit in the *Drosophila melanogaster* brain and its modulation in response to alcohol use and stress.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Kaun Lab – Undergraduate Researcher

September 2023-present

Quantifying morphology and connectivity of a two-neuron circuit in the *Drosophila* mushroom body responsible for ethanol preference. Independently planned experiments, analyzed data, mentored new trainees, and created original figures in preparation for project writeups and poster presentations.

Cooper Lab – Undergraduate Researcher

March 2023-June 2023

Conducted telephone screenings, data entry, and measured vitals for participants in studies analyzing the effects of cannabis on pain tolerance and hunger.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

Hernandez, J.S., **Wang, M.**, Le, N., Azanchi, R., Mei, N., Kaun, K.R. A dopaminergic circuit for motivated alcohol use in *Drosophila* (*In progress*).

Wang M., Hernandez, J.S., Mei, N.J., Azanchi, R., Kaun, K.R. (2024, October). Investigating the relationship between neuronal morphology and alcohol preference in *Drosophila*. Poster session presented at Society for Neuroscience 2024, Chicago, IL

Wang M., Hernandez, J.S., Mei, N.J., Azanchi, R., Kaun, K.R. (2024, October). Investigating the relationship between neuronal morphology and alcohol preference in *Drosophila*. Poster session presented at Brown Summer 2024 Undergraduate Research Symposium, Providence, RI

TEACHING

BIOL 0280 (Biochemistry) Undergraduate Teaching Assistant January 2025-present
Hosted weekly conference sections and office hours to go over course material, and proctored and graded exams.

PHYS 0040 (Basic Physics B) Tutor September 2024-present
Led mini lectures and created practice problems for students once a week. Answered students' questions related to course content and test-taking strategies.

LEADERSHIP

President & Captain of Brown Quiz Bowl September 2024-present
Competed at three national-level collegiate tournaments, ran weekly practices, and arranged finances and logistics for tournament travel.

Transfer & Resumed Undergraduate Education (TRUE) Peer Advisor August 2024-present
Led small cohort of incoming transfer students around campus for orientation and answer any questions about academics and student life at Brown.

AWARDS AND HONORS

2025 Boston Area Drosophila Meeting Poster Award - 2nd Prize June 2025
Presented the second-best poster at the 2025 Boston Area Drosophila Meeting.

Brown University Advanced Undergraduate Research Fellowship April 2025
Awarded \$2,500 to continue my original research project from May-August 2025. Fellows are required to attend weekly workshops to improve scientific communication, network, and learn about research ethics.

Research at Brown (RAB) Grant September 2024
Received \$250 to attend Society for Neuroscience 2024.

Brown University Undergraduate Teaching and Research Award (UTRA) April 2024
Awarded \$2,500 to conduct full-time research during the summer for 10-12 weeks. Findings were presented at the 2024 Brown Summer Research Symposium in August 2024.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Society for Neuroscience 2024-present

Undergraduate Research Consortium in Functional Genomics 2023-present

SELECTED SKILLS

Laboratory: Fine tissue dissection, immunohistochemistry, gel electrophoresis, confocal microscopy, expansion microscopy

Technical: Google Suite, Microsoft Office, FIJI/ImageJ, R, Python, GraphPad Prim, Fluorender, Amira

Languages: English (native), Mandarin (native), French (intermediate)